PAIN MANAGEMENT



Significant acute postoperative pain is common, even among those on an established pain management protocol. [1]

Pain after surgery is associated with increased risk of postoperative readmission to hospital, emergency department visits, myocardial injury, delirium, and chronic pain. [2-7] Postoperative pain control may be improved by addressing modifiable patient risk factors such as sleep, BMI, depression, anxiety, and preoperative pain. [8]

Screening Tools

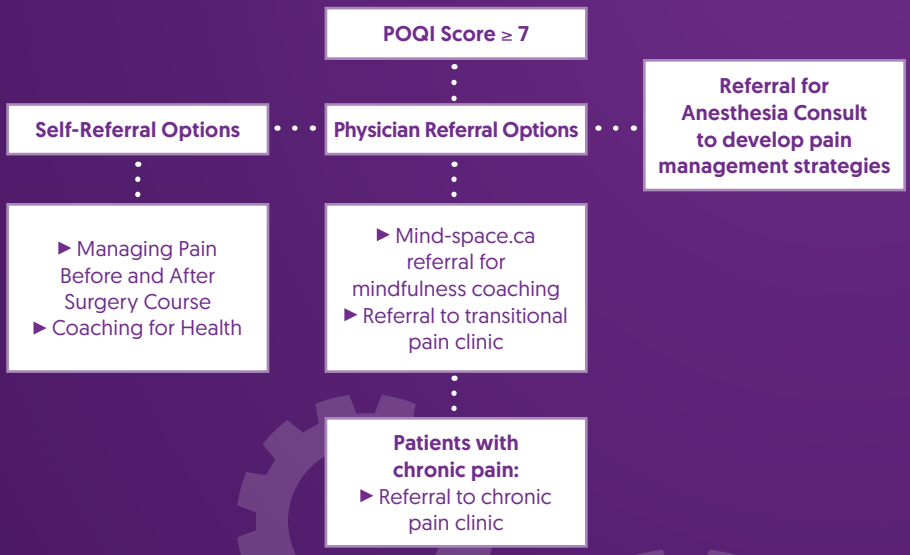
The Perioperative Opioid Quality Improvement (POQI) score is an algorithm being developed at St. Paul's Hospital. It aims to identify patients at increased risk of significant postoperative pain and long-term opioid use, so that their care plans may be tailored with the intent of helping reduce initial opioid consumption. [9] It incorporates several variables associated with increased risk for developing postoperative pain and uses consumption of > 90 morphine milligram equivalents per day while inpatient after surgery as a surrogate marker for assessing performance. [9] While the POQI score is not validated, it was selected to support postoperative pain risk stratification based on local BC experience with the tool. A POQI score ≥ 7 is considered to be 'increased risk.'

Perioperative Opioid Quality Improvement (POQI) Algorithm

	YES	Scoring (if Yes)
History of chronic pain	☐	4
History of anxiety or panic attacks	☐	2
History of depression	☐	2
History of poorly controlled pain after surgery	☐	2
Current prescription for opioids	☐	5
Current prescription for benzodiazepines	☐	4
Current prescription for antidepressants	☐	4
Recreational drug use (history of or present)	☐	4
Substance use disorder (history of or present)	☐	5
Age <40	☐	1
Female	☐	2

SCORING
Add all **YES** scores together for a total between 0-35.

PAIN MANAGEMENT ALGORITHM



Prehabilitation and Optimization Recommendations

Patient Education	⚙ Set patient expectations for postoperative pain management ⚙ "Given your risk factors, managing post-surgery pain might be challenging. There are many ways we can work together before and after surgery to decrease this."
Self-Referral Options	⚙ Refer to online patient resources including access to the following: • Managing Pain Before and After Surgery (PainBC): A free self-paced online program for people having surgery and their families to better manage pain after surgery and decrease complications • Coaching for Health (PainBC): A free one-on-one telephone coaching program designed to help people living with chronic pain learn self-management skills, regain function, and improve well-being
Referral for Anesthesia Consult	⚙ To develop effective pain management strategies and explore options for anesthesia and postoperative pain control, especially in moderate to severely invasive surgery

Physician-Referral Options

- Mind-space.ca - Mindfulness teaching virtually
- Referral to Transitional Pain Clinic
  - Transitional pain clinics are short-term outpatient services that manage pain before and after surgery to prevent acute pain from becoming chronic. Currently available at Vancouver Coastal Health and Providence Health sites.
- Referral to Chronic Pain Clinic